MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第7回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第7回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To keep morning hikers safe after the frost, rangers sprinkled sand to ( ) the risk of slipping on wooden steps.

1 modernize **2** memorize **3** maximize **4** minimize

(2) Because the island clinic has limited storage space, medical supplies are delivered ( ) rather than once a season.

1 bitterly **2** biweekly **3** bluntly **4** broadly

(3) Although the new railway timetable drew complaints at first, commuters soon came to ( ) its smoother express transfers.

1 allocate **2** anticipate **3** appreciate **4** aggravate

(4) All outdoor pottery kilns were shut down for the afternoon ( ) strong gusts forecast across the valley.

1 on account of **2** in spite of **3** on behalf of **4** by means of

(5) Before opening the restored wooden theater to audiences, the city had every emergency exit ( ) by fire inspectors.

1 varied **2** vanished **3** violated **4** verified

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Consumers have become increasingly ( ) of vague "eco-friendly" labels that provide no third-party proof.

1 wary **2** worthy **3** wealthy **4** warm

(7) A five-minute stretch break between study hours provides welcome ( ) from eye strain and stiff shoulders.

1 regret **2** relief **3** remedy **4** reform

(8) Should any passenger ( ) motion sickness during the crossing, ginger tea and cold towels are available at the cabin counter.

1 experienced **2** experiences **3** experience **4** experiencing

(9) Traditional earthen walls absorb moisture on rainy days and release it when indoor air becomes overly ( ).

1 ample **2** arid **3** acute **4** agile

(10) To protect river salmon laying eggs, gravel extraction from the upper stream has been ( ) from September through November.

1 surpassed **2** sustained **3** suspected **4** suspended

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) The two research teams arrived at the same conclusion, though their experimental methods were ( ) different.

1 fundamentally **2** faintly **3** formally **4** fondly

(12) Prolonged exposure to loud power tools without ear protection can result in ( ) hearing loss.

1 portable **2** punctual **3** permanent **4** plentiful

(13) In an effort to ( ) ties between generations, the elementary school invited retired craftspeople to teach woodworking.

1 flutter **2** falter **3** flatter **4** foster

(14) While smartwatches track step counts accurately on flat sidewalks, they still have ( ) measuring effort when carrying heavy groceries upstairs.

1 authority **2** capacity **3** difficulty **4** priority

(15) Volunteers spent Saturday morning clearing invasive vines to prevent them from ( ) out young native beech trees.

1 cheering **2** choking **3** carving **4** calling

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(16) The municipal swimming pool offers discounted early-bird passes to residents, regardless of their employment (　　).

1 status　**2** statue　**3** stature　**4** statute

(17) Faced with rising flour and butter prices, the family bakery chose to trim box decorations rather than (　　) ingredient quality.

1 comprehend　**2** compensate　**3** compliment　**4** compromise

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Escalators and Stairs Use Contrasting Step Edges

Commuters hurrying through brightly lit rail stations rarely notice the narrow yellow or metallic strip running along the front edge of every stair and escalator step. Often mistaken for simple trim or anti-slip tape alone, these high-contrast strips—known in accessibility codes as step nosings—play a vital perceptual role in preventing falls.

When an entire staircase is built from uniform gray granite or stainless steel, overhead lighting can make adjacent steps blend visually into a single flat ramp, especially for older adults, tired evening travelers, or people with low vision. Descending stairs requires the brain to judge the exact drop and forward edge of the top and bottom steps within a fraction of a second. Marking each edge with a band whose brightness differs sharply from the tread surface breaks that optical illusion. (18), walkers place their heels more accurately without slowing down.

Color choice matters more than decoration. Pale beige strips on light limestone look stylish in architectural photos, yet offer almost no luminance contrast under cloudy skylight. Building guidelines therefore measure light reflectance values rather than hue alone, ensuring the strip remains distinct even in dim emergency lighting. (19), embedding gritty mineral particles into the nosing strip adds traction right where shoe soles pivot.

Combining visual clarity with physical grip demonstrates how inclusive design (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 As a consequence
3 Regardless
4 Until recently

(19)

1 Instead
2 Otherwise
3 Furthermore
4 Conversely

(20)

1 protects everyone on busy stairs rather than serving only a small group
2 makes gray granite stairs look like smooth ramps on purpose
3 replaces all station lighting with yellow flashlights
4 encourages commuters to jump three steps at a time

How District Cooling Chills Buildings from Underground Pipes

Walk past a row of glass office towers on a sweltering August afternoon, and you might expect every rooftop to roar with its own bank of air-conditioning condensers. In dense districts of cities such as Sapporo, Stockholm, Toronto, and Singapore, however, many large buildings contain no individual chillers at all. Instead, they draw icy water from a shared underground loop operated by a central "district cooling" plant.

Pooling cooling demand across dozens of offices, hospitals, and shopping arcades unlocks efficiencies that single buildings cannot match. Offices peak at two in the afternoon while hotels need more cooling at night, allowing one central plant to run steady, high-efficiency turbines rather than starting and stopping dozens of small motors. Central plants can also tap natural cold sources unavailable to individual rooftops—such as deep lake water, seawater, or winter snow stored in insulated pits until July. (21), electricity demand during summer heat waves drops sharply.

Urban neighborhoods feel the difference outdoors too. Individual rooftop units pump hot exhaust air straight into narrow streets, worsening the urban heat-island effect right where pedestrians walk. Moving heat rejection to a single waterfront facility keeps downtown air noticeably cooler and quieter. (22), freeing up rooftop space allows architects to install solar panels or shaded sky gardens.

Digging insulated pipe networks beneath existing streets requires heavy upfront investment, so district cooling works best in compact areas. Even so, shared thermal networks offer cities (23).

(21)

1 Previously
2 Nevertheless
3 On the other hand
4 Consequently

(22)

1 In addition
2 Otherwise
3 By contrast
4 Instead

(23)

1 a reason to build glass office towers in remote deserts only
2 a powerful way to cut peak energy use while cooling crowded streets
3 free snow delivery to every suburban single-family house
4 higher street noise during August afternoons

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Updated Policy for Borrowing Field Recording Kits

From: Media Lab Desk, Faculty of Cultural Studies
To: Undergraduate Fieldwork Students
Subject: Windscreens and memory-card rules for oral-history kits

Dear students,
Starting next Monday, six upgraded stereo audio kits will be available for two-week loan to students conducting local oral-history interviews this semester. Before reserving a kit online, please note two updated borrowing rules based on issues from last autumn.

First, every kit now includes a furry "deadcat" wind muff alongside the standard foam sponge cover. Foam covers stop indoor breath pops, but they cannot block wind rumble on porches, farms, or fishing piers; three outdoor interviews last term were almost impossible to transcribe because of wind noise. Whenever you record outdoors, slip the furry wind muff over the microphone before pressing record.

Second, the Media Lab no longer lends SD memory cards inside the cases. Last year, two students accidentally returned kits before copying their files, and our automatic formatting bench erased a week's worth of recordings. Please purchase your own Class-10 SD card (32 GB or 64 GB) at the campus co-op and test it in the recorder at the pickup counter before leaving.

Happy interviewing,
Media Lab Staff

Updated Policy for Borrowing Field Recording Kits — Questions

(24) Why must students attach the furry wind muff when recording outdoors?

1 Interviewees speak louder when they see a furry microphone.

2 Furry covers keep rain from rusting the SD card slot.

3 Standard foam covers only block indoor breath sounds and fail against outdoor wind noise.

4 Foam sponge covers were removed from all six cases.

(25) Why did the Media Lab stop lending SD memory cards with the audio kits?

1 SD cards became too expensive for the university budget.

2 Students returned kits before backing up files, leading to accidental erasure during formatting.

3 New stereo recorders operate only with cassette tapes.

4 The campus co-op asked for higher memory-card sales.

(26) What should students do at the pickup counter before leaving with a kit?

1 Record a thirty-minute interview with lab staff.

2 Format the lab's hard drive.

3 Pay a two-week rental fee in cash.

4 Test their own purchased SD card inside the recorder.

Why Bookbinders Still Sew Heavy-Use Books with Thread

Pick up an inexpensive paperback novel, and you will see its pages held together by a thin layer of flexible glue along a flat spine. Invented to speed up mass publishing in the twentieth century, adhesive "perfect binding" made books affordable for millions of readers and works admirably for novels read once or twice on a train. Ask a chef, pianist, or reference librarian which binding they trust, however, and many will immediately point to sewn signatures.

In traditional Smyth-sewn binding, large printed sheets are folded into small booklets of sixteen or thirty-two pages—called signatures—and stitched through the fold with strong cotton or linen thread before all the booklets are linked together. The practical difference appears the moment you set the book on a table. Because glued paperbacks rely on stiff spine adhesive to grip individual cut edges, pressing a paperback flat on a kitchen counter or piano music desk often cracks the spine and sends loose pages fluttering to the floor. A sewn book, by contrast, flexes along its folded hinges and lies wide open hands-free without straining the binding.

Longevity matters just as much for archives and schools. Even high-grade synthetic glues gradually oxidize and turn brittle over decades, especially in dry heated rooms or humid tropical libraries. Linen thread stitched through acid-free paper routinely endures for centuries; when a sewn library dictionary eventually wears out its cloth cover, a conservator can replace the outer case while leaving the intact text block untouched.

Modern automated sewing machines have narrowed the cost gap, allowing textbook publishers and art museums to order sewn runs without handcraft delays. Glued paperbacks will always dominate airport bookstalls, yet wherever a book must stay open on a workbench or serve generations of readers, needle and thread remain unmatched.

Why Bookbinders Still Sew Heavy-Use Books with Thread — Questions

(27) What was the major advantage of adhesive "perfect binding" when it spread in the twentieth century?

1 It sped up mass production and made paperback books inexpensive for wide readerships.

2 It allowed books to survive underwater for centuries.

3 It enabled piano scores to lie completely flat without any hands.

4 It eliminated the need for paper in publishing.

(28) Why do cooks and musicians especially value Smyth-sewn books?

1 Sewn books weigh half as much as glued paperbacks.

2 Sewn pages are waterproof against soup spills.

3 They flex at the folded hinges and stay wide open flat on a counter or music stand without losing pages.

4 Every sewn book comes with free audio recordings.

(29) What happens to adhesive bindings over decades compared with sewn bindings?

1 Conservators cannot repair the outer cover of a sewn book.

2 Glued spines grow stronger in dry heated rooms.

3 Thread dissolves into powder within five winters.

4 Adhesives can oxidize and turn brittle, whereas linen thread on acid-free paper lasts for centuries.

(30) How does a sewn binding simplify repair when a heavy library dictionary wears out?

1 Pages rearrange themselves alphabetically overnight.

2 Librarians melt the linen thread in a microwave.

3 A conservator can replace the worn outer cover while keeping the stitched text block intact.

4 Each page can be photocopied without opening the book.

Why Bookbinders Still Sew Heavy-Use Books with Thread — Questions (continued)

(31) What is the author's conclusion about glued and sewn books today?

1 Glued paperbacks will vanish completely from airport shops next year.

2 Both methods have their place, with thread remaining superior for flat-opening and long-lived books.

3 Automated sewing machines ruined the quality of museum art books.

4 Readers should tear the spines off all novels before boarding trains.